5.2.8 GPRS

General Packet Radio Service is a data transfer method used with GSM networks. In this method, data is transferred in packets using the Internet Protocol (IP), rather than in streams. Data transfer rates for GPRS vary from 56 to 114 Kilobits per second. It is a step slower than the EDGE (Enhanced Data GSM Environment) protocol, which delivers data at maximum rates of 384 Kilobits per second. Apple's iPhone is a GPRS / EDGE enabled device.

5.2.9 GSM

Global System for Mobile communications is a 2G mobile network technology and currently the most popular globally, with a market share of more than 80 per cent. It is used by about 700 operators in 214 countries, covering 29 per cent of the global population. In GSM, voice signals are digitised, then compressed, and sent along with two similar data streams in different time slots but the same frequency spectrum (900 MHz or 1800 MHz). This indicates that it uses TDMA (Time Division Multiple Access) to send data. GSM networks also offer a degree of data encryption.

5.2.10 HSPA

High Speed Packet Access is based on the UMTS protocol. It is divided into two standards: HSDPA (HS Downlink PA) and HSUPA (HS Uplink PA). HSDPA is also known as "3.5G" and has theoretical data transfer rates of 8 ~ 10 Megabits per second. Multimedia and streaming video is the primary focus of HSDPA networks. Most new high-end phones come with HSDPA services enabled, though very few carriers support these high speeds.

5.2.11 UMTS

Universal Mobile Telecommunication System is a 3G-based wireless communication technology for cell phones using WCDMA as the air interface. UMTS is also called 3GSM because the protocol was intended to succeed GSM networks, and also used the GSM infrastructure to connect.